

Employing in Belgium

What You Need to Know · Employment Hero HeroForce EOR · July 2026

What does the EOR handle for you?

- **Employment contracts** — compliant contracts referencing the applicable Joint Committee (Paritair Comité/Commission Paritaire) CBA
- **Monthly payroll** — salary payments in EUR, itemised payslips
- **Tax withholding** — bedrijfsvoorheffing/précompte professionnel withheld and remitted
- **ONSS/RSZ** — the national social security office contribution stack
- **Leave and termination management** — notice periods, entitlements and severance guidance

Employment Conditions

Contracts & Probation

Belgium abolished formal probationary periods for standard employment contracts in 2014 — new hires are protected by standard notice rules from day one, though a short informal trial period is common in practice.

Item	Detail	Legal Basis
Probation period	Formally abolished since 2014; standard notice rules apply from day one	Unified Status Act (2014)
Joint Committee (CBA)	Sets sector-specific pay scales and additional terms on top of the Labour Act	Collective bargaining
Wage indexation	Automatic wage indexation tied to the health index applies in most sectors	Sector CBA / national mechanism

Working Hours & Overtime

Rule	Detail	Authority
Standard hours	38 hours/week (statutory reference; many CBAs set 36–40)	Labour Act
Overtime premium	150% (weekdays), 200% (Sundays/public holidays)	Labour Act
Double holiday pay	Additional payment of ~92% of monthly salary, paid alongside annual leave	Statutory (vakantiegeld/pécule de vacances)

Employer Social Security (ONSS/RSZ, 2026)

Measure	Rate	Notes
Employer contribution (white-collar)	~27% of gross salary	Basic contribution ~25% + additional contributions ~3%
Employer contribution (blue-collar)	~33% of gross salary	Higher due to additional sector-specific and vacation-fund contributions
High-earner exemption	Basic ~25% contribution exempted above €85,000/quarter	Programme Act 18 July 2025; the ~3% additional contributions and the employee's 13.07% remain payable in full
Employee contribution	13.07% of gross salary (flat, no ceiling)	Uniform across sectors and salary levels

Leave Entitlements

Leave Type	Entitlement	Who Pays	Key Condition
Annual Leave	20 days/year (based on prior year's work; pro-rated for new entrants)	Employer	Plus "double holiday pay" of ~92% of monthly salary, paid separately
13th Month Salary	Not mandated nationally; near-universal via sector CBA	Employer	Set at Joint Committee level, covering the large majority of private-sector employees
Maternity Leave	15 weeks (up to 19 for multiple births)	Health insurance fund (mutualité/ziekenfonds)	1 week mandatory before + 9 weeks mandatory after birth
Paternity/Birth Leave	20 days	Employer (first 3 days) + health insurance fund (remaining days)	Must be taken within 4 months of birth

Payroll, Tax & Contributions

Total Cost Example — USD \$3,000 Gross Monthly Salary

Cost Item	Amount (USD)	% of Gross
Gross salary	\$3,000.00	100%
Employer ONSS contribution (illustrative, 27%, white-collar)	\$810.00	27.00%
EOR service fee (HeroForce, Tier 2)	\$600.00	20.00%
Estimated total monthly cost	~\$4,410.00	~147.0%

HeroForce EOR service fee shown at USD \$600 per employee per month (Tier 2 pricing), no setup fee. This excludes double holiday pay and any CBA-mandated 13th month salary, which

add further annualised cost typical of Belgian employment (a realistic all-in multiplier is often 1.35–1.45× gross). Employee deductions (withheld separately) include the flat 13.07% ONSS share and progressive income tax plus communal surcharge.

Income Tax (2026)

Belgian personal income tax is progressive, with an additional municipal surcharge (typically 6%–9%) calculated on the national tax liability, varying by commune.

Feature	Detail
National income tax range	25% – 50%, progressive by bracket
Municipal surcharge	~6%–9% of national tax liability, varies by commune
Impatriate regime	35% lump-sum expense reimbursement available for qualifying inbound employees, reducing both tax and social security base

Termination & Separation

Belgium's Unified Status Act (2014) sets a single notice/severance framework based on length of service, replacing the old blue-collar/white-collar distinction. Notice periods scale from 2 weeks (under 3 months' service) up to 1 week per year of service beyond a certain point, capped by detailed statutory tables — employers may also pay compensation in lieu of notice (indemnity in lieu, calculated on remaining salary and benefits for the notice period).

★ HERO TIP

Belgian termination law is widely regarded as one of the most employee-protective in Europe, and severance packages are generally taxed separately using the employee's average tax rate from the prior year rather than standard progressive withholding. Always route Belgian terminations through your HeroForce EOR to confirm the correct notice/indemnity calculation before issuing notice — the tables are detailed and easy to miscalculate.

Public Holidays 2026

Belgium observes 10 national public holidays in 2026.

Date	Holiday	Type
1 January	New Year's Day	National
6 April	Easter Monday	National
1 May	Labour Day	National
14 May	Ascension Day	National
25 May	Whit Monday	National
21 July	Belgian National Day	National
15 August	Assumption Day	National
1 November	All Saints' Day	National
11 November	Armistice Day	National
25 December	Christmas Day	National

Ready to hire in Belgium?

HeroForce by Employment Hero is an Employer of Record solution that handles hiring, contracts, compliance and payroll across 180+ countries.

Onboard your first Belgium employee in as little as one to two weeks — HeroForce EOR service fee: **USD \$600** per employee per month, no setup fee (Tier 2).